

owned by someone or something and is the result of creative work. Examples are Duke Nukem, Halo, God of War, Mario, Lara Croft, Spiderman, etc. All of them are legally protected by their owners. According to the Game Market's survey, best-selling game titles are derived from pre-existing IPs. Generally IP games are owned by the developer or the publisher. Big IP games like Halo and World of Warcraft are quite profitable and have a lot of brand-value in the Game market. Licensed IPs also exist where publishers buy a pre-existing IP for using it in their games.

- ▶ **Story:** This is a common approach followed in video games. The story gives an idea of the game world. Sometimes, it might represent the chronological timeline of a person or a company.

b. Taking an idea to a formal concept

Getting a game idea is the first and a minor step in the Game development process. Many people have ideas; but to bring it to the end of completion there are many more steps to follow and that too for perfection to create a game of quality. A Game Concept is different from an idea. It concentrates on how



Halo

you intend to entertain someone through your game-play and at a deeper level, why you believe it will be a compelling experience.

To bring your million dollar idea to a concept, you need to sit for hours and formalize whatever is left assumed back in your mind. Some of these would prove helpful:

Making a high-concept statement

Create a high-concept statement. It is generally a 2-3 sentence description of what the game is about. It should describe what feeling it gives to a player and if possible what's new. It should be a "boilerplate" description of your game. This helps in finding publishers and used for promotional and marketing purposes.

For an example, high-concept statement of Bio Shock would look like:

Bio Shock is a horrifying, sophisticated, visually stunning, open-ended experience that will leave players gasping for breath. It's a first person action nightmare that will scare the hell out of people.